

PROGRAMME: HND II ACCOUNTANCY

Course: Professional Career Development

Code: OTM 325 Credit Hours: 4 hours

Course Lecturer: Halilu Hamman

Course Main Aim/Goal: This course is designed to further expose students to the knowledge and skills necessary for professionalism and upward mobility in their careers.

General Objectives:

- 1.0 Understand competencies for job success and mobility.
- 2.0 Understand job responsibilities of office workers.
- 3.0 Understand the importance of further education and training.
- 4.0 Know the role of interpersonal relations in an organization.
- 5.0 Know the importance of time management.
- 6.0 Know how to go about job search.

1. Profession and Career

One of the most crucial decision in a person's life is to choose the right career for him/her. A career can be understood as the occupation, which an individual undertakes throughout his life, and includes all the steps taken for growth. The life pattern of a person is defined by the career he/she opts.

The term 'career' is often misconstrued as 'profession', but there is a fine line of differences between the two. A profession is an occupation, usually paid, which requires a person to undergo prolonged training from a particular university, polytechnic, or any recognize institution of learning.

Profession vs Career

Basis for Comparison	Profession	Career
Meaning	Profession refers to an activity, in which a person applies his/her specialized knowledge and skill, in the occupation.	Career defines a person's work life, as in the jobs, work profiles, salary, growth and development opportunities, etc.
Occupation	Profession itself is an occupation	Business, Profession or Employment
Based on	Education and training	Ambition
Orientation	Service oriented	Growth oriented
Code of Conduct	It has a code of conduct.	No such code of conduct.

Career and profession both are long-term endeavours of life. While career encompasses all the jobs, business or any other type of work performed by an individual during his life, the profession is an occupation for which a person should have good knowledge and expertise, to provide services to others.

2. COMPETENCIES FOR JOB SUCCESS AND MOBILITY:

What is Job Competency?

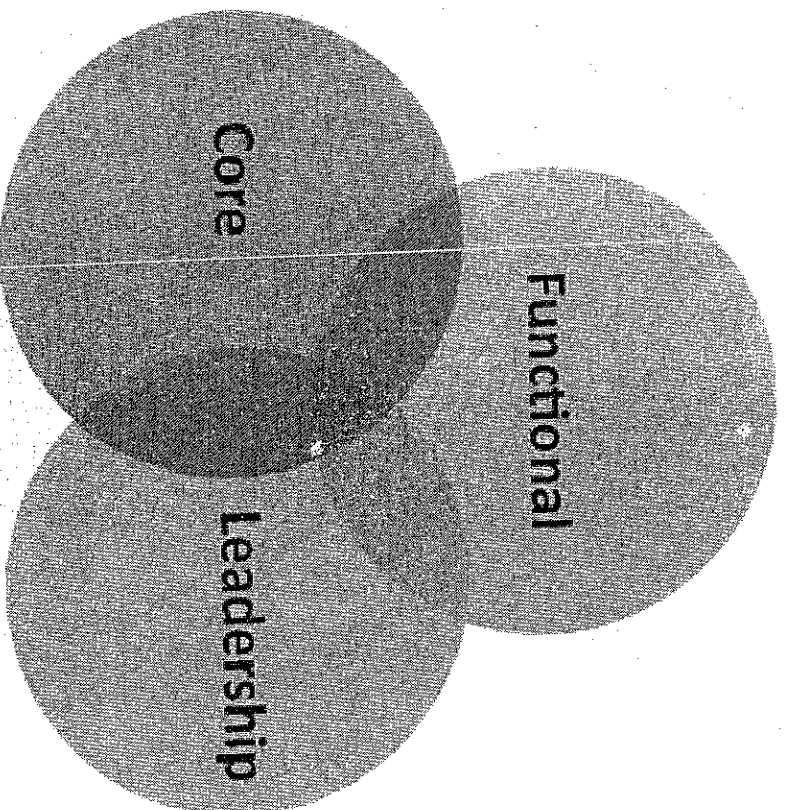
Competencies: The Building Blocks for Career Mobility

As the labor pool continues to shrink and the quit rate continues to rise, talent professionals are dealing with challenges in retaining key talent. It is not a stretch to think that some of your very best employees may currently be considering career options outside your company. In this blog post, we'll explore how you can use competencies to build a career pathing program designed to retain, engage, and leverage your talent.

Competency

A **competency** describes the observable abilities, skills, knowledge, motivations, and traits, defined in terms of the behaviors, needed for successful job performance. They define the behaviors required for success at the different proficiency levels that are aligned with the hierarchy of roles within the organization.

A group of competencies, defined at the appropriate proficiency level, can be amalgamated into a **competency profile** that describes the competency requirements that predict job success. Depending on the role type, these competencies may include core competencies, leadership competencies, and functional competencies.



- **Core competencies** are required in all jobs and expected of all employees. They are aligned to the vision and values of the organization.
- **Functional competencies** define the competencies that are needed for success in specialized fields. Functional competencies include technical competencies, which equate to "hard" or applied knowledge and skills, or universal competencies, which equate to "soft" or transferrable skills.
- **Leadership competencies** capture the essence of effective leaders and translate it into measurable behaviors.

The value of competencies in career mobility

In a traditional career pathing framework, organizations develop career ladders for each function. A career ladder is a traditional, hierarchical career movement based on an employee's education, background, or experience. Although this is an easy and straightforward approach, it limits the employee's options to move between functions. A lattice approach facilitates this mobility.

Competencies can enable a lattice approach to career mobility in your organization by providing the common currency that connects jobs across the organization and provides paths to both vertical and lateral career opportunities.

Let's look at some of the ways in which competencies support more flexible, "latticed" career paths.

Competency profiles ensure that validated criteria are used in career mobility decisions.

Competencies enable good talent decisions

Competencies can easily be translated into a "success profile" for each role. The success profile includes the competency profile as well as the qualifications required for success.

A success profile can be used to assess and select talent for roles. Not only do competencies assist in making objective, fair, and equitable selection decisions, but they also help predict employee success.

This is one area where role-based career ladders fail. Some organizations look at the time an employee spends in a specific role or previous experience to determine readiness for a vertical move. This thinking is flawed in many ways. It is one thing to move an employee into a role, and quite another to ensure that each employee is ready and prepared to be successful once they assume the duties of their new role. The problem with experience is that it does not necessarily equate to competence. Just because someone spent years in a role does not mean that they have acquired or demonstrated a competency to the level required. Because competencies are designed to be measurable, they provide more rigor in making talent decisions than relying on an employee's experience in a different role.

Competencies can act as a beacon to confirm that candidates are ready for a specific role by proving that they can demonstrate the necessary behaviors (the 'how'), at the required level of proficiency, to achieve expected performance outcomes (the 'what').

Organizations should ask 2 critical questions:

1. Do we enable the movement of our internal employees based on competencies?
2. Are these employees successful in their new roles once moved?

Competencies ensure better succession management decisions

Competencies can help to identify the future leaders of your organization. One commonly held belief when it comes to succession management is: "The best performers are the best leaders." Unfortunately, this is a fallacy. Often, organizations resort to intuition and unconscious biases when categorizing employees as high-potential future leaders. But there is too much at stake to allow leadership choices to be guided by anything other than objective facts.

A better, less biased, and more equitable approach to assessing leadership potential is to use a common set of leadership competencies (including proficiency levels) to accurately assess your talent pool. This approach ensures that the executive team uses valid, observable, and measurable behaviors to assess where each employee is today, including a deeper understanding of their readiness for future leadership roles.

Competencies also provide common, consistent language to ensure that each employee receives detailed, actionable feedback on their current leadership strengths and opportunities.

Developmental feedback is a critical step to help employees build specific action plans aimed at improving or strengthening identified leadership competencies.

Competencies support more diverse career paths

Well-designed competency profiles limit the number of competencies required for any one role. This simplifies the career paths because there is a limited number of competencies in which successful candidates need to be proficient.

And because every role is constructed from the same competency "building blocks," this also enlarges the potential talent pool, since you can now consider internal candidates from a variety of different backgrounds, roles and functions in your selection decisions.

Instead of looking within each function for candidates to fill the next vacancy or going outside the company to hire an external candidate, managers can use competencies to identify a broader, potentially deeper pool of interested, motivated, and skilled internal candidates to select from.

Using a competency-based approach to career pathing isn't perfect, nor is it a magic bullet to cure all your HR ailments. Every employee has different competencies, and not every employee will be qualified for the role they are interested in. There may be barriers to entry for certain jobs—a CPA designation for accounting roles, for example, or a P.Eng. designation for engineering roles—and this will not go away regardless of the career pathing framework you employ.

The good news is that if an internal candidate is not selected for their dream role, the use of competency profiles enables managers to provide transparent feedback based on the specific behaviors the candidate demonstrates in their role. In partnership with the candidate's manager, the employee can develop an action plan to strengthen specific competencies and potentially quality, over the longer term, for the desired role.

Competencies help employees navigate their career choices

Ensuring that employees have the tools, resources, and support to navigate their career choices can be challenging. A lot of organizations promote the philosophy that the employee is the "CEO of their career." However, it is one thing to say this and quite another for employees to experience it. The primary goal of any internal mobility program is to ensure that employees are free to explore career opportunities without having to leave your organization to do so.

Core competencies can be seen as "transferable" and therefore incorporated into many roles in the organization. This allows individuals to see the commonalities between different functions or career paths more easily. Competencies allow companies to identify the minimum criteria (competencies and proficiency levels) for each job, which enables broader, more diverse applicant pools. Rather than listing 15-20 specifications (i.e., qualifications, skills, education and/or experiences) relating to the perfect candidate, a company can prioritize the most important competencies in an ideal candidate. This is an important way to foster career mobility

because it reinforces that the company is open to considering employees who have diverse backgrounds and work experiences. Remember, the whole objective is to increase career mobility by creating **more** potential career pathways for employees to explore.

Once these success profiles are developed for each role, employees are fully empowered to:

1. **Reflect** on their career interests and aspirations
2. **Identify** their career destination
3. **Build** a plan to get there

In other words, if you know the competencies needed in your target role, you can consider whether you are a good fit for the role today. Also, competencies (and required proficiency levels) can provide a roadmap by showing how you can develop from one role to the next, whether it is a lateral, vertical, horizontal, or downwards move.

New paths, new narrative

The effect of the "Great Resignation" is real, but it can be a catalyst for talent professionals to start developing programs that improve the workplace experience for employees. A career pathing program built with competencies sends a powerful message that the organization recognizes the value of their employees and is committed to empowering and retaining them. The goal is to create an environment where new, non-traditional career paths are enabled in ways that have not been considered or allowed previously.

With every employee career move and every subsequent success story, you are creating a new narrative in your organization—one reinforcing the importance and commitment to employee development and career growth through a sustained focus on career mobility.

Core Competencies are Key to Career Mobility

Most people attempting to identify and secure a new job understandably try to sell their experience and skills to land that next position. That works in many cases, but far too often merely trying to link direct skills and experience is not enough to win the day, especially when you are in tough competition for a job or have experiential gaps and are looking to do something different.

So what if you want to pursue a job that you have never really done before? How do you convince someone you are qualified for a role if you have little or no experience performing in that specific role? How do you compete for a position when you have less experience than someone else? The answer is to identify and leverage your job related competencies to secure the new position. In addition to other assessments I have increasingly have placed emphasis on administering a sound competency assessment process on behalf of clients in transition to help them secure their position of choice.

Competencies are innate skills, abilities and behaviors that employees are expected to effectively demonstrate to carry out the mission, goals and values of the organization and

perform optimally within their individual roles. They enable and support an employee's capacity to effectively perform their job-specific tasks and responsibilities. Competencies are part of your professional DNA that is programmed into you just like your personality or behavior style. Your core competencies represent your natural wiring to do a job effectively. They are the transferable abilities that enable you to do a job successfully.

The word "innate" is defined as "*the ability comes directly from the mind and natural internal forces rather than being acquired by experience or from external sources such as education.*" Actively leveraging your competency based abilities combined with effective training and coaching are often times all you need to do a job well. If you possess a core competency to do a task you're more likely to be good at it and enjoy doing it because it is the essence of how you best operate that is being expressed through your work.

To properly identify and leverage your competencies requires access to a credible competency model, embedded in a proven evaluation process and interpreted by a qualified professional. There are hundreds of competency models that range from 50 to 150 specific competencies. Competency models often link to many factors and layers within a company such as industry, job function, employee level and corporate-wide technical standards and values. Knowing how to identify and align with competency levels are critical to your success in landing a position with any organization that values how competencies affect job alignment and performance. Even more important is possessing the ability to clearly demonstrate versus merely declare your competencies in an interview. More on this when you click on Interviewing? Offer Solutions and Win the Job

The following represent a small sample of competency families and specific competencies:

1. **Personal and Relational Competencies.** Flexibility, decisiveness, tenacity, independence, approachability, collaboration, personal integrity, values driven, conflict management, perseverance
2. **Leadership Competencies.** Leadership, empowerment, strategic planning, command skills, decision making, directing others, delegation, influencing others, persuasiveness, managerial courage, dealing with paradox, risk tolerance, strategic agility, action oriented, composure, risk-taking
3. **Managerial, Operational and Administrative Competencies.** Action oriented, project management, operational effectiveness, priority setting, coordinating ability, multitasking, managing and measuring work, organizing, planning, focus on quality, priority setting, process management, discerning when/how to act
4. **Business and Financial Competencies.** Business acumen, financial awareness, corporate sensitivity, understanding cause and effect, organizational agility, strategic and tactical application, financial cause and effect.
5. **Analytical and Technical Competencies.** Thinking, analyzing, reasoning, problem solving, logical or methodical skills, technical acumen, problem solving, practical learning, information assimilation, attention to detail, deductive reasoning, intellectual horsepower, learning on the fly, functional association

6. **Interpersonal and Communication Competencies.** Effective communication, diplomacy, intuition, emotional intelligence, self-awareness, negotiation, teamwork, openness, collaboration, patience, comfort with higher management, listening acumen, peer relationships, presentation skills, written communications.
7. **Motivational and Inspirational Competencies.** Resilience, achievement, initiative, drive for results, ability to inspire, challenge, motivation,
8. **Creative and Inventive Competencies.** Innovation, vision creation, imaging, collaborative inquiry, crafting, creative curiosity, conceptualizing. So the next time you are sizing yourself up for new position and trying to communicate your ability to perform, link your core competencies, skills and experience to the criteria required of the position. Do this effectively by telling S.T.A.R. Stories (Situation, Task, Action, Result) that relate specifically to the topic(s) you are discussing and you'll be in great shape to win the job.

3. JOB RESPONSIBILITIES OF OFFICE WORKER

What Does an Office Worker Do?

An office worker is responsible for performing administrative and clerical duties to support the daily operations of the business. Office workers assist in receiving calls to respond to the clients' inquiries and concerns, as well as welcoming visitors, verifying their appointments, and leading them to the appropriate personnel and department for their business needs. They also do data processing, sorting mail, and filing documents for easy retrieval and reference, especially during meetings and company activities.

Office Worker Responsibilities

Here are examples of responsibilities from real office worker resumes representing typical tasks they are likely to perform in their roles.

1. Manage daily office operations maintaining accurate records for payroll and other checks.
2. Train in installing windows, showers and glass into homes and commercial businesses.
3. Used QuickBooks to accurately compute and produce invoices to be mail to various customer companies.
4. Serve as office secretary, organizing files, answering phones, delivering payroll and deposits, organize incoming mail and invoice's.
5. Assist patients with sensitive and detail orient documentation, schedule appointments and verify insurance benefits.
6. Operate 10-key calculators, typewriters, and copy machines to perform calculations and produce documents.

Attend, generate and refer telephone calls and guide citizens as appropriate.

Most office workers list "data entry," "administrative tasks," and "powerpoint" as skills on their resumes. We go into more details on the most important office worker responsibilities here:

1. Customer-service skills can be considered to be the most important personality trait for an office worker to have. According to a office worker resume, "general office clerks often provide general information to company staff, customers, or the public" office workers are able to use customer-service skills in the following example we gathered from a resume: "organized data entry information into corporate database and processed products to be shipped to customers."
2. Another commonly found skill for being able to perform office worker duties is the following: detail oriented. According to a office worker resume, "general office clerks perform many clerical tasks that require attention to detail, such as preparing bills." Check out this example of how office workers use detail oriented: "job details: money handling paying bills scheduling appointments ordering inventory & parts answering calls creating spreadsheets billing filing customer service"
3. Organizational skills is also an important skill for office workers to have. This example of how office workers use this skill comes from a office worker resume, "general office clerks file and retrieve records" Read this excerpt from a resume to understand how vital it is to their everyday roles and responsibilities, "assisted with various tasks concerning filing and organization of important documents* extensive work with microsoft excel* data entry and organizational duties"

What Administrative Office Specialists Do

An administrative office specialist helps offices to run efficiently and smoothly by performing clerical support tasks. Their responsibilities often include preparing and processing documents, arranging meetings and appointments, monitoring the budgets and expenditures and developing strategies to optimize office operations. They may also address issues and concerns, resolving them promptly and professionally. Furthermore, as an administrative office specialist, it is essential to coordinate staff, all while implementing the company's policies and regulations.

There are some key differences in responsibilities as well. For example, an office worker responsibilities require skills like "scheduling appointments," "office machines," "computer system," and "computer programs." Meanwhile a typical administrative office specialist has skills in areas such as "phone calls," "hr," "travel arrangements," and "provides administrative support." This difference in skills reveals how truly different these two careers really are.

What Are The Duties Of a Front Office Specialist?

A front office specialist performs varied duties and administrative tasks for an organization. These include maintaining the cleanliness of the front desk, greeting and welcoming guests and visitors, and answering questions and managing complaints. Other duties include answering telephone calls, receiving packages and letters, and checking, sorting, and

forwarding emails. As front office specialist, you are expected to maintain updated files and records, prepare various types of written materials, and research a wide range of topics as requested.

How a Business Office Associate Compares

Business office associates are responsible for providing clerical and administrative support to the office staff for efficient and smooth operations of the office operations. They typically perform a number of tasks that include managing and entering data to spreadsheets and databases, organizing and maintaining files and documents, and assisting with bookkeeping activities. Additionally, they are responsible for managing work projects and overall office management, collaborating with other departments, and maintaining financial documents and customer information. Business office associates are also expected to oversee human resource activities such as handling of employment forms and administering health insurance.

Description of an Office Receptionist

An office receptionist, or administrative assistant, performs various administrative tasks for an organization. These tasks may include answering phone calls, providing the public and customers with information, and warmly welcoming, greeting, and directing visitors or guests accordingly. Additionally, an office receptionist is responsible for maintaining security by issuing visitor badges, monitoring logbooks, and following procedures. Administrative assistants are also responsible for preparing and processing travel vouchers and other documents. Some employers prefer someone with a college or bachelor's degree, telephone skills, and excellent communication skills.

4. THE IMPORTANCE OF FURTHER EDUCATION AND TRAINING.

Reasons to Pursue Further Education and Additional Training for Professionals

Professional development is an important part of maintaining a successful career in this competitive economy. Many professionals have been in the workforce for years and still feel that they aren't doing everything they can to stay on top of their game. As a result, they end up pursuing continuing education or investing in more training.

For example, an entrepreneur who has a degree in business should not stop there. This entrepreneur should pursue more training so that they can learn new things and develop new skills. This way, they can become a better leader and provide value to the company. With that in mind, professionals need to know what they should invest time into learning about.

The Importance of Training and Continuing Education for Professionals

Choosing continuing education or additional training depends on your current level of expertise and how much you want to grow as an individual. Continuing education is more appropriate for professionals who are not looking to change careers or relocate, while additional

training is more common for professionals who want to advance their careers and increase earning potential.

If you are a professional looking to continue your education to further develop as an individual, continuing education might be the best option. Pursuing relevant courses can help professionals gain the necessary skills to positively impact their workplace or even prepare them for a bigger role in their industry.

On the other hand, investing in training is important because professionals need to ensure that they have the most up-to-date skills to stay competitive. For professionals looking for a change, training can provide them with the necessary tools and knowledge base needed to switch careers or get ahead of their coworkers. This way, professionals don't risk spending time and money on a career change only to find out they lack the necessary skills and knowledge.

The More the Merrier

In some cases, professionals pursue continuing education and additional training at different points throughout their careers because they want to further their knowledge and expertise. However, professionals might also need training and additional courses for work-related reasons or due to company guidelines.

Regardless of the reason professionals choose to pursue continuing education and additional training, having a plan in place can help them make sure that they can establish a competitive advantage that will help them succeed in their careers.

Reasons to Pursue Continuing Education and Additional Training for Professionals

Below are some of the reasons why professionals should choose to pursue continuing education or additional training:

1. Becoming more competent

Professionals who continuously pursue continuing education and additional training are more likely to become experts in their fields. Therefore, they'll be able to become more competent professionals and set themselves apart from their competition.

2. Establishing a competitive advantage through knowledge

Having the necessary skills and training that allow professionals to establish a competitive advantage can help them secure new jobs or even start their own businesses, increasing their chances of success in an ever-changing job market. A competitive advantage is essential, especially when professionals are looking to advance their careers.

3. Achieving professional development

Continuing education and additional training allow professionals to acquire new skills. Still, they can also help professionals find out more about the latest technologies used in future career advancements. This will ensure professionals' success by helping them stay ahead of the competition and becoming a valuable asset to their companies.

The US Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) shows that professionals with additional training and continuing education have higher employment rates than those who do not receive further training beyond their bachelor's degree. This applies to professionals in various industries such as healthcare workers or managers, engineers, information technology professionals, teachers, and professionals in finance.

Professional development is a crucial part of professionals' career path as it helps them find their passion in the field they have chosen. It also ensures that professionals stay up-to-date with skills training to provide better services to their clients while keeping themselves competitive in today's job market.

4. Gaining a promotion becomes easier

Professionals who pursue continuing education or additional training find it easier to secure a promotion or a pay raise. It is also possible for professionals to break into new and more rewarding roles with their current employers after gaining training in other fields considered the professionals' interests. As a result, professionals can gain a higher level of satisfaction from their work because they enjoy what they do and are confident about their skills, knowledge, and capabilities.

5. Working for a Better Future

Professionals should do what they can to improve their skills and their knowledge about the industry they are working in. Continuing education and additional training help professionals be more valuable to employers, meaning professionals can continue to provide for themselves and pursue a better future.

5. IMPORTANCE OF INTERPERSONAL RELATIONSHIP AT WORKPLACE

Interpersonal relationship refers to a strong association among individuals working together in the same organization. Employees working together ought to share a special bond for them to deliver their level best. It is essential for individuals to be honest with each other for a healthy interpersonal relationship and eventually positive ambience at the workplace.

Importance of interpersonal relationship at workplace.

- **An individual spends around eight to nine hours in his organization and it is practically not possible for him to work all alone.** Human beings are not machines who can work at a stretch. We need people to talk to and share our feelings.

Imagine yourself working in an organization with no friends around!!!! We are social animals and we need friends around.

An individual working in isolation is more prone to stress and anxiety. They hardly enjoy their work and attend office just for the sake of it.

Individuals working alone find their job monotonous. It is essential to have trustworthy fellow workers around with whom one can share all his secrets without the fear of them getting leaked. We must have friends at the workplace who can give us honest feedback.

- **A single brain alone can't take all decisions alone.** We need people to discuss various issues, evaluate pros and cons and reach to solutions benefiting not only the employees but also the organization on the whole.

Employees can brainstorm together and reach to better ideas and strategies. Strategies must be discussed on an open platform where every individual has the liberty to express his/her views. Employees must be called for meetings at least once in a week to promote open communication. Interaction on a regular basis is important for healthy relationship.

- **Interpersonal relationship has a direct effect on the organization culture.** Misunderstandings and confusions lead to negativity at the workplace. Conflicts lead you nowhere and in turn spoil the work environment.
- **We need people around who can appreciate our hard work and motivate us from time to time.** It is essential to have some trustworthy co workers at the workplace who not only appreciate us when we do some good work but also tell us our mistakes.

A pat on the back goes a long way in extracting the best out of individuals. One needs to have people at the workplace who are more like mentors than mere colleagues.

- **It always pays to have individuals around who really care for us.** We need colleagues to fall back on at the times of crisis. If you do not talk to anyone at the workplace, no one would come to your help when you actually need them.
- **An individual needs to get along with fellow workers to complete assignments within the stipulated time frame.** An Individual working all alone is overburdened and never finishes tasks within deadlines.

Support of fellow workers is important. You just can't do everything on your own. Roles and responsibilities must be delegated as per specialization, educational qualification and interests of employees. An individual needs help of his fellow workers to complete assignments on time and for better results.

Tips to Improve Interpersonal Relations at Workplace

Interpersonal relationship refers to a strong association among employees either working together in the same team or same organization. Employees must get along well for a positive and healthy ambience at the workplace.

Tips to improve interpersonal relationship at workplace.

1. **Do not treat office as your home.** There is a certain way of behaving at the workplace. It is essential to be professional at work. Never misbehave with any of your colleagues. Legpulling, criticism, backbiting are a strict no no. It is better to avoid someone you don't like rather than fighting or arguing with him/her. Your office colleagues can be your friends as well but one must know where to draw the line. Too much of friendship is harmful and spoils relationship among employees.
2. **An individual should not interfere in his colleague's work.** Superiors must formulate specific KRAs for all the employees and make sure job responsibilities do not overlap. Overlapping of job responsibility leads to employees interfering in each other's tasks and eventually fighting over small issues. One should be concerned only with his work rather than trying to find out what the other employee is up to.
3. **Give space to your fellow workers.** Giving space infact is essential in all relationships. Overhearing anyone else's personal conversation is strictly unprofessional. An employee must not open envelopes, couriers or letters not meant for him. Such practices lead to severe displeasure among employees and eventually spoil relationships.
4. **Do not spread baseless rumours at workplace.** Even if you know something about someone, learn to keep things to yourself. Discuss it with the individual concerned in private rather than publicizing the whole thing. Organization has nothing to do with anyone's private matters.
5. **Pass on correct information to others.** If your superior has asked you to share some information with any of your colleagues, make sure it is shared in its desired form. Data tampering and playing with information spoil relationships among colleagues and lead to confusions at the workplace.
6. **Do not share all your secrets with your co workers.** You never know when they might misuse them. Even if you do, make sure you are doing it with someone you trust blindly.
7. **Leave your ego behind.** Do not bring your personal tensions to work. Think before you speak. Making fun of colleagues is something which is not at all expected out of a professional.
8. **A team leader should not scold any of his team members in front of others.** It might insult him/her. Call the individual concerned either to your cabin or conference room. Avoid comparisons among team members. The employees must be strictly judged according to their work and nothing else. Employees doing well should be suitably rewarded.
9. **Stay away from nasty politics at workplace.** Do not try to harm anyone. It is absolutely okay to appreciate someone who has done something exceptionally well. Avoid being jealous. It will harm you in the long run. There should be healthy competition among the employees for a healthy environment at the workplace.

MANAGING CONFLICT IN INTERPERSONAL RELATIONSHIP AT WORKPLACE:

When two individuals have different opinions and neither of the two is willing to compromise, conflict arises. A state of disagreement among individuals is called as conflict. Conflict arises at workplace when employees find it difficult to reach to mutually

acceptable solutions and fight over petty issues. Differences in attitude, mindsets and perceptions give rise to conflicts at the workplace.

No one ever has gained anything out of conflicts. Conflict must be avoided as it leads to negativity and spoils the ambience of the workplace.

How to manage conflicts in interpersonal relationship at workplace:

Conflicts play an important role in spoiling relationship among employees at the workplace and must be controlled at the initial stages to expect the best out of individuals.

1. For individuals, organization should always come first and all other personal interests must take a backseat. Fighting with fellow workers on petty issues is childish. Be professional. Do not take things to heart at the workplace as no one is working for himself or herself. You might not like someone else's style of working but remember ultimately the organization must benefit out of it.
2. **An individual ought to respect his colleagues.** Treat your fellow workers as members of your extended family. Ignoring minor issues helps in avoiding conflicts in interpersonal relationship. Try to understand your colleague's point of view as well.
3. **Avoid lobbying at the workplace.** An individual should keep his personal and professional life separate. Do not favour anyone just because you like the individual concerned or you know him personally.

At work, every employee irrespective of his family background and relation with the management needs to be treated as one. Ignoring or bad mouthing someone just because you do not like him is simply not acceptable. Such things give rise to unnecessary stress and eventually employees fight and spoil relationships amongst themselves. You need people around who can give you suggestions and help you when required. You can't work alone.

4. **Remember there is a difference between being aggressive and rude.** A sense of competition is essential among employees but make sure you adopt healthy means to prove yourself. Jealousy, backbiting, criticism, leg pulling give rise to disgracements among individuals and spoil their relationships.
5. Think before you speak. Do not hurt anyone. There are several other ways to express your displeasure at work. Do not overreact at workplace. Stay calm and composed.
6. Avoid being arrogant. Be polite to everyone. Greet people and do enquire about their well being. A simple smile goes a long way in managing conflicts and strengthening interpersonal relationships at workplace.
7. **Evaluate issues carefully.** Do not jump to conclusions. It is always better to sort out differences amicably rather than fighting and spoiling relationships. Voice your concerns in an open platform and try to reach to a conclusion mutually acceptable to all. Do not always see your own personal interests
8. Learn to control your emotions.
9. Communicating effectively reduces the chances of errors and eventually manages conflicts amongst employees at the workplace.

6. BENEFITS OF TIME MANAGEMENT

Time management is the process of organizing and planning how to divide your time between specific activities and priorities. The benefits of time management include better habits and greater productivity. Improved time management increases your focus, builds confidence, and allows you to plan your time more effectively.

Benefits of Time Management:

1. Less stress managing your time reduces your stress level and increases your confidence. Taking control of your time also reduces stress and anxiety. Good time management means meeting tight deadlines and planning your time.

Managing your time stops overwhelm and ensures you don't feel tired all the time. Good time management enables you to be more productive with the time you have. Increased productivity ensures you stay on top of your to-do list and prioritize your most important work. With less stress, you feel clear and more confident about how to invest your time.

Less stress increases productivity and helps you sleep better. It also helps create a better work-life balance.

Act. Identify three causes of stress that impact your ability to manage your time. Get clear on the causes of stress and outline the difference it would make if you could eliminate this stress. Pick the biggest cause of stress and set one action you can take to eliminate that stress.

2. Better work-life balance. One of the most important benefits of time management is a better Work-life balance. If you achieve a better work-life balance, you can be more productive at work and have more time to spend on your most important relationships.

Work-life balance creates a good balance between your professional life and personal life. When you spend long hours at work, you risk burnout and feeling tired all the time.

3. More time freedom. One of the key benefits of time management is greater time freedom. When you have greater time freedom, you can focus your time on setting and achieving your biggest goals.

Greater time freedom also ensures you have more time to spend with family and friends. You have more time to deepen relationships and pursue new hobbies. Having more time freedom also allows you to follow your purpose in life.

Act. Ask yourself what you would do if you could free up an additional five hours or ten hours a week. Write down the three most important things and get clear on the difference

doing those things would make in your life. Then, layout a simple action plan to make those changes a reality.

4. Greater focus. Effective time management increases your focus and improves your productivity. Greater focus allows you to capture bigger opportunities. It also allows you to spend more time on the projects, goals, and people that matter. Time management is important in helping you achieve greater focus and prioritization. When you better manage your time, you increase focus and take control of your day. Good time management doesn't mean expanding your to-do list and working longer. Time management means working smarter, not harder. When you manage your time, you have a greater focus on your most productive activities. This helps build positive habits. It also ensures you spend more time on the activities that help you reach your goals.

5. Higher levels of productivity. Good time management skills increase your productivity and help you get more done. Time management skills help you reduce stress and prioritize your time. Effective time management clarifies your goals and prioritizes your most important tasks. As a result, you have more time to achieve bigger and better results.

When you manage your time, you can plan your day and increase your performance. Daily planning improves your productivity. Planning your time is an important element of time management. Planning increases productivity and effectiveness.

To be more productive with your time it's important to identify your daily priorities. Identifying your priorities helps you spend your most productive time working on them.

6. Less procrastination. Procrastination happens when you don't manage your time. When you aren't clear and focused on your goals, it's easy to procrastinate. Poor time management causes distraction and procrastination. Building effective time management skills and managing time ensures you don't procrastinate. Managing your time ensures you feel in control of your workload, which helps to stop procrastination.

When you feel focused and in control of your time, you are less likely to procrastinate. When you are clear and focused on your goals, you spend more time working on your biggest priorities.

Act. Identify the three biggest causes of your procrastination and layout the first action step you can take to eliminate each of the causes one by one.

7. Things are simpler and easier. Effective time management skills make things simple and easy. When you take control of your time, you are more confident and capable. Good time management ensures you feel clear and confident about how to use your time. As a result, you stop feeling overwhelmed, stressed, and frustrated.

Good time management enables you to work on your goals and make effective to-do lists. This planning helps you prioritise your most important tasks. As a result, you invest your time and energy to produce the outcomes and results you want.

Discover the best time management tips to prioritise your time more effectively.

8. Less distraction. Effective time management eliminates distractions and boosts concentration. Distraction impacts your time management and lowers your productivity.

Developing effective time management skills increases focus and limits distractions. When you manage time, you can plan better and prioritise better. This helps you schedule your most important work.

Effective time managers set aside chunks of time to work on their most important work. Additionally, they set better boundaries around their time to increase focus.

Better boundaries increase focus ensures you focus your time on your biggest priorities. It also helps reduce overwhelm and distraction.

9. Increased energy. One of the biggest benefits of managing time is greater energy and motivation. When you work longer and harder your energy levels can drop, and you feel tired all the time.

Good time management skills help you manage your energy and productivity levels. One of the most important benefits of time management is greater energy. Increased energy helps you focus on your most important work.

When you have more energy, you are more focused and productive for longer. When energy levels drop, it's easier to get overwhelmed and start procrastinating. Good time managers schedule their time and take regular breaks throughout the day. To manage your time, keep your energy levels high to increase productivity.

10. Time to think. Effective time management techniques give you more time to think and plan.

Planning your time ensures you have more time to work on your biggest priorities. With more time to strategise, you have more time to focus on achieving your goals.

Poor time management means you don't have time to make progress on your biggest goals. Having time to think about how to make progress on your goals is as important as taking action.

Good time management ensures you have time for strategic and creative planning time. As a result, you can be more productive and focused with the time you have.

Summary:

The benefits of time management include greater clarity, greater capability, and greater confidence. When you are clear on the best use of your time, you become more focused and productive. Good time management helps you achieve bigger goals, reduces procrastination, and increases productivity.

Effective time management reduces overwhelm and helps you prioritise, ensuring you work smarter and achieve your goals faster. One of the best ways to manage your time better and get more done is to work with a personal coach like WORK & MOVE Software to plan your time more effectively.

If you feel busy but not productive and want to free up more time, improve your time management give us a call and we will tell you all about our software solution.

7. HOW TO GO ABOUT JOB SEARCH

SOME OF THE GUIDE TO EFFECTIVE JOB SEARCHING:

1. Thinkright

Many people rush at a job search and apply for roles they have little interest in or are unlikely to be shortlisted for. Not only will this pretty much guarantee rejection, it will dampen your confidence. Similarly, if you approach agencies with a poor sense of your target job, you are likely to be sidelined. The third biggest mistake is to use up all your best contacts too soon when you're unclear how they can help. Slow down, take time to look at yourself and your confidence levels; consider how equipped you feel to summarise your strengths.

2. Take stock

Before you become a one-person marketing machine, think about what you're selling. Do you know what you're looking for? What job titles are relevant to you? Can you list your main skills? Do you have evidence of achievements? Which employers appeal to you and why? Don't go near busy decision-makers until you have answers to all these questions.

3. Plan for rejection

Even in a buoyant market, rejection is common; in today's economy you will hear no a lot more than you hear yes. To maintain your confidence and avoid becoming a job beggar desperate to take anything, cultivate resilience. But don't squander it by applying for jobs far outside your skills range, where you're unlikely to get any kind of response. Recruit two or three supporters who you can meet regularly to remind you what you're good at, broaden your thinking and help pick you up when you receive inevitable knock-backs.

4. Gather evidence

Before you begin drafting a CV or stumble into interviews, list raw material from your past without editing. Draw up a long, unfiltered list of what you've done. Go over every part of your experience which looks like work, including part-time, temporary, unpaid posts and work placements. List every skill you learned and practiced, sectors where you have work experience and anything that looks like an achievement. Then look at volunteering, your studies and activities outside work. Try to gather several pages of material before deciding on the primary message for the lead part of your CV.

5. Decide on your three main messages

Anyone who recommends you is likely to pass on only three or four items of information about you — your experience, ability and personality. You have more control over this process than you think. Scrutinize the first few sentences of your CV. Make sure they are positive, memorable and clearly outline what you want to achieve. How likely it is that someone will repeat this information? Do you make clear what you have to offer and the kind of role you'd like to fill? Emphasize these messages in your CV, social media profile and what you say when networking.

6. Research before you job search

It's no use trying to impress employers if you have very little sense of what will press their buttons. Do your homework thoroughly before making any kind of approach — at least two hours of research. If you're called to interview, make your research even more thorough. Don't just repeat information from the organization's website — try to speak to people who know what the organization is trying to achieve and the kind of people they're currently looking for. If you're trying to make a career change, seek out people who have made the leap before you, learn the shortcuts and avoid the bear traps.

7. Market test your CV

Don't be under the illusion that you should send out your CV widely in the early stages of your job search. It's far better to talk to people about your career ideas and gather information than to send out a poorly drafted document, which will close more doors than it opens. You may be secretly pleased with your CV but it's vital to show it to someone with hiring experience. Ask for a summary rather than an opinion. For example, don't ask "what do you think of my CV?" ask "what does my CV tell you about what I can do next?" If the answer is brief and makes sense, your CV is probably working.

8. Get interview feedback outside the process

Many jobseekers waste real job interviews as practice sessions. Interviews are hard enough to get; don't waste them by making basic errors. Find someone who has interviewing experience who will give you honest feedback on first impressions, how you link your experience to the job on offer and how well you handle tricky questions. Practice short, upbeat answers to tricky questions about gaps in your CV or why you're job seeking right now. Don't ignore vital job-related topics or the dull but obvious questions, such as 'tell us about your strengths and weaknesses'.

9. List and research target organizations

People will need examples of the kind of organizations you're interested in to help you. This matters even more if you're trying to make a career change; you'll be a much more credible candidate if you've researched the sector in-depth and can say something about the main players.

It's also smart to identify employers in your locality. Build up a list of six or so target organizations and spend time every week learning more about them, trying to get closer to them through mutual connections, exploring job boards and generally doing everything you can to pitch yourself as a potential employee.

10. Use a multi-channel approach

Make direct approaches to organizations who are not currently advertising, build relationships with the right recruitment agencies, talk to people in interesting roles and sectors, and research like mad. Above all else, don't kid yourself that spending all day in front of a computer screen is the best use of your time; get in front of people too. At least once a week put on smart clothes, find someone to meet so you can practice talking about yourself and what you're looking for. It maintains your confidence levels and ensures you're remembered.